Kioxia Holdings (285A.T)

Addressing investor FAQs following 2Q results; reiterate Buy

285A.T	12m Price Target: **¥39,000**	Price: **¥11,345**	Upside: **243.8%**

BUY

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Reiterate Buy; no change in strong fundamentals or proactive stance on shareholder returns

While Kioxia Holdings' share price has been on a downward trend post its 2Q results announcement due to factors such as 3Q3/27 guidance coming in below market expectations and the lack of any announcement on an additional share buyback, we see no negative factors to alter our view of earnings growth from 4Q into FY3/28. We reiterate our Buy rating and 12-month target price of ¥39,000 (we fine-tune our earnings forecasts by less than 1% after reviewing capex timing assumptions and other factors). Following management's announced commitment to return 100% of surplus FCF, we see a high likelihood that additional shareholder returns, centered on share buybacks, will be announced in 4Q or FY3/28.

Below, we summarize recent investor FAQs (quarterly earnings outlook, details of long-term agreements, and shareholder returns) and our views on each.

Key topic (1): Trends in quarterly earnings

Volume: For 3Q3/27, guidance is for volume to be flat qoq; from 2Q to 3Q, Kioxia expects an increase for smart device applications, and a plateauing of volume for SSD and storage applications. However, it expects the volume weighting for data center and enterprise applications to rise significantly into 4Q, and according to the company, overall bit growth from 3Q to 4Q is expected to be high-single-digit to c.10% qoq, within which bit growth for smart device applications are expected to decrease.

Pricing: 3Q3/27 blended ASP guidance calls for a low- to mid-single-digit % increase qoq in USD terms. While this may appear to be somewhat modest due to a higher weighting of lower-priced products for smart devices, Kioxia expects like-for-like

Key Data

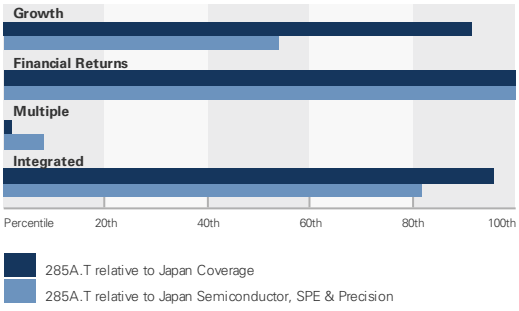
Market cap: ¥18.1tr / $114.9bn
Enterprise value: ¥16.9tr / $106.9bn
3m ADTV: ¥1.5tr / $9.5bn
Japan
Japan Semiconductor, SPE & Precision
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥ bn)	2,337.6	10,103.3	14,170.2	16,870.0
Op. profit (¥ bn) New	**870.4**	**8,080.7**	**11,936.7**	**14,282.0**
Op. profit (¥ bn) Old	870.4	8,079.2	11,934.4	14,264.2
Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	–	–	–	–
EPS (¥) New	**341.4**	**3,519.2**	**5,388.7**	**6,847.4**
EPS (¥) Old	341.4	3,518.5	5,387.6	6,838.8
P/E (X)	8.0	3.2	2.1	1.7
P/B (X)	3.2	3.2	1.7	1.3
CROCI (%)	25.5	101.8	106.6	108.4

	9/26	12/26E	3/27E	6/27E
EPS (¥)	836.0	910.8	1,259.1	1,301.8

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

Kioxia Holdings (285A.T)

Rating since May 31, 2026

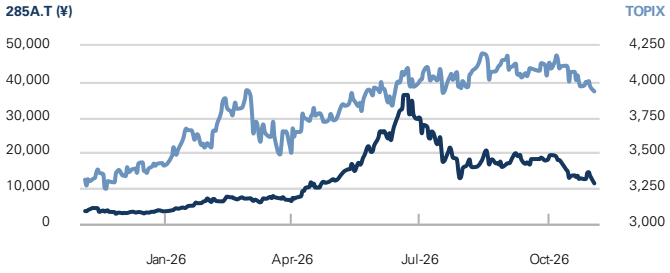
Ratios & Valuation

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
P/E (X)	8.0	3.2	2.1	1.7
P/B (X)	3.2	3.2	1.7	1.3
FCF yield (%)	13.8	20.9	42.0	57.1
EV/EBITDAR (X)	4.4	2.0	1.1	0.7
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	4.3	2.0	1.1	0.7
CROCI (%)	25.5	101.8	106.6	108.4
ROE (%)	51.9	157.5	105.1	86.2
Net debt/equity (%)	55.9	(22.1)	(40.9)	(46.8)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	41.2	(24.9)	(42.2)	(47.6)
Interest cover (X)	9.0	164.2	590.9	772.0
Days inventory outst, sales	59.8	17.3	14.9	14.4
Receivable days	70.2	63.5	88.3	94.9
Days payable outstanding	162.3	156.3	167.1	165.6
DuPont ROE (%)	39.6	97.9	82.3	76.6
Turnover (X)	0.6	1.3	1.2	1.1
Leverage (X)	2.6	1.3	1.2	1.2
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (¥)	4,552.4	7,145.9	8,825.1	9,946.3
Average capital employed (¥)	1,661.8	3,146.3	5,092.2	6,353.2
BVPS (¥)	854.0	3,593.9	6,548.8	8,937.8

Growth & Margins (%)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue growth	37.0	332.2	40.3	19.1
EBITDA growth	54.9	612.3	46.3	19.5
EPS growth	97.0	931.0	53.1	27.1
DPS growth	NM	NM	66.7	40.0
EBIT margin	37.2	80.0	84.2	84.7
EBITDA margin	50.6	83.4	87.0	87.4
Net income margin	23.7	55.7	58.9	59.2

Price Performance



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	(26.8)%	(6.5)%	214.4%
Rel. to the TOPIX	(25.4)%	(11.3)%	166.5%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 2 Nov 2026 close.

Income Statement (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue	2,337.6	10,103.3	14,170.2	16,870.0
Cost of goods sold	(1,235.5)	(1,611.6)	(1,826.3)	(2,110.3)
SG&A	(146.6)	(240.3)	(269.6)	(310.9)
R&D	(89.3)	(136.9)	(149.6)	(178.8)
Other operating inc./(exp.)	4.0	(33.8)	12.0	12.0
EBITDA	**1,183.2**	**8,428.4**	**12,332.3**	**14,742.8**
Depreciation & amortization	(312.8)	(347.7)	(395.6)	(460.8)
EBIT	**870.4**	**8,080.7**	**11,936.7**	**14,282.0**
Net interest inc./(exp.)	(87.2)	(42.8)	(13.3)	(11.1)
Income/(loss) from associates	0.9	1.2	1.3	1.4
Pre-tax profit	**784.1**	**8,039.1**	**11,924.7**	**14,272.3**
Provision for taxes	(229.6)	(2,411.7)	(3,577.4)	(4,281.7)
Minority interest	–	–	–	–
Preferred dividends	–	–	–	–
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	**554.5**	**5,627.4**	**8,347.3**	**9,990.6**
Post-tax exceptionals	–	–	–	–
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	**554.5**	**5,627.4**	**8,347.3**	**9,990.6**
EPS (basic, pre-except) (¥)	**341.4**	**3,519.2**	**5,388.7**	**6,847.4**
EPS (diluted, pre-except) (¥)	**341.4**	**3,519.2**	**5,388.7**	**6,847.4**
EPS (basic, post-except) (¥)	**341.4**	**3,519.2**	**5,388.7**	**6,847.4**
EPS (diluted, post-except) (¥)	**341.4**	**3,519.2**	**5,388.7**	**6,847.4**
DPS (¥)	–	300.0	500.0	700.0
Div. payout ratio (%)	0.0	8.5	9.3	10.2

Balance Sheet (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Cash & cash equivalents	470.7	1,902.2	4,723.4	6,623.4
Accounts receivable	660.6	2,855.0	4,004.2	4,767.1
Inventory	412.6	544.6	615.4	713.0
Other current assets	74.0	74.0	74.0	74.0
Total current assets	**1,617.8**	**5,375.7**	**9,416.9**	**12,177.4**
Net PP&E	1,055.3	1,165.4	1,329.8	1,269.0
Net intangibles	584.9	584.1	584.1	584.1
Total investments	227.3	228.5	229.8	231.2
Other long-term assets	204.8	255.0	492.3	776.4
Total assets	**3,690.1**	**7,608.7**	**12,052.9**	**15,038.0**
Accounts payable	594.9	785.2	887.4	1,028.0
Short-term debt	175.5	25.4	25.4	25.4
Short-term lease liabilities	43.9	30.1	26.6	22.0
Other current liabilities	283.7	283.7	283.7	283.7
Total current liabilities	**1,098.0**	**1,124.5**	**1,223.0**	**1,359.1**
Long-term debt	872.1	446.8	421.4	396.0
Long-term lease liabilities	161.7	131.6	105.0	83.0
Other long-term liabilities	159.2	159.2	159.2	159.2
Total long-term liabilities	**1,193.0**	**737.5**	**685.5**	**638.2**
Total liabilities	**2,291.0**	**1,861.9**	**1,908.6**	**1,997.3**
Preferred shares	–	–	–	–
Total common equity	**1,398.9**	**5,746.6**	**10,144.2**	**13,040.6**
Minority interest	**0.2**	**0.2**	**0.2**	**0.2**
Total liabilities & equity	**3,690.1**	**7,608.7**	**12,052.9**	**15,038.0**
Net debt, adjusted	576.9	(1,430.1)	(4,276.6)	(6,202.0)

Cash Flow (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Net income	554.5	5,627.4	8,347.3	9,990.6
D&A add-back	312.8	347.7	395.6	460.8
Minority interest add-back	–	–	–	–
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(400.3)	(2,136.1)	(1,117.9)	(719.8)
Other operating cash flow	149.5	(51.4)	(238.6)	(285.4)
Cash flow from operations	**616.5**	**3,787.6**	**7,386.4**	**9,446.2**
Capital expenditures	(0.5)	(1.6)	(1.5)	(1.5)
Acquisitions	–	–	–	–
Divestitures	–	–	–	–
Others	(221.0)	(455.4)	(558.5)	(398.5)
Cash flow from investing	**(221.5)**	**(457.0)**	**(560.0)**	**(400.0)**
Repayment of lease liabilities	–	–	–	–
Dividends paid (common & pref)	–	(479.7)	(774.5)	(1,021.3)
Inc/(dec) in debt	(80.8)	(619.4)	(55.5)	(52.0)
Other financing cash flows	(11.5)	(800.0)	(3,175.2)	(6,072.9)
Cash flow from financing	**(92.3)**	**(1,899.1)**	**(4,005.2)**	**(7,146.2)**
Total cash flow	**302.8**	**1,431.5**	**2,821.2**	**1,900.0**
Free cash flow	616.0	3,786.0	7,384.8	9,444.7

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

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growth to be stronger than on a blended basis. With major customer Apple (c.20% of sales in FY3/26) also expressing the view at its recent results briefing that memory prices will continue to rise, we believe the mild pace of ASP growth in 3Q is a temporary factor.

Key topic (2): Details of long-term agreements (LTAs)

Per the company, the coverage ratio of bit shipments under multi-year LTAs substantially exceeds 50% for both CY27 and CY28 (coverage has risen compared to three months ago), and CY27 is already fully allocated, including 1-year contracts. Notably, even for multi-year LTAs, prices are not locked in at a fixed level; rather, while securing a certain floor price, shipments remain subject to quarterly price negotiations, with no particular price ceiling set.

Key topic (3): Thoughts on shareholder returns

Since Kioxia Holdings on a non-consolidated basis has exhausted the amount available for dividend distributions under the Companies Act, the company did not announce any additional share buyback at 2Q results. Although this amount under the Companies Act is normally determined once per year at full-year results, management plans to conduct an extraordinary closing of accounts for Kioxia (the operating company) on a half-year basis, followed by an extraordinary closing of accounts to bring the dividend into the holding company, with the distributable amount expected to increase around Jan-Mar 2027 when the submission of its audit report is expected to be completed.

Regarding maintaining a cash buffer equivalent to roughly three months of sales mentioned at the results briefing, Kioxia explained that 1) its definition is on a gross cash basis (not net cash), which already includes the level necessary for future tax payments and growth investments such as capex (meaning it does not imply securing cash for growth investments or necessary expenditures in addition to three months of sales), and 2) this is not a message that additional shareholder returns will not be executed unless three months of cash is secured. On capex, FY3/27 guidance is around ¥470 bn (a slight increase from initial guidance of ¥450 bn), and while its expectation for an annual average of ¥470 bn over the 3-year period FY3/27-FY3/29 is intact, it noted that investments are running somewhat ahead of schedule.

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Exhibit 1: Kioxia HD: Earnings summary

Kioxia HD (285A)													
(JPY mn)		GSE	GSE	GSE							GSE	GSE	CoE
Consolidated income statement	3/2026	3/2027	3/2028	3/2029	3/2026 1Q	3/2026 2Q	3/2026 3Q	3/2026 4Q	3/2027 1Q	3/2027 2Q	3/2027 3Q	3/2027 4Q	3/2027 3Q
Sales	2,337,628	10,103,300	14,170,200	16,870,000	342,799	448,346	543,631	1,002,852	1,767,117	2,480,035	2,570,600	3,285,600	2,500,000
Non-GAAP operating profits	876,170	8,131,500	11,936,700	14,282,000	45,214	87,163	144,654	599,139	1,326,200	1,988,410	2,081,100	2,735,773	2,000,000
IFRS operating profits	870,369	8,080,700	11,936,700	14,282,000	44,899	85,921	142,754	596,795	1,270,017	1,994,710	2,080,900	2,735,073	1,995,000
Pre-tax profits	784,095	8,039,100	11,924,700	14,272,300	27,294	56,716	121,740	578,345	1,234,720	1,968,670	2,079,200	2,756,510	
Non-GAAP net profits	559,638	5,666,200	8,347,300	9,990,600	18,507	40,436	89,519	411,176	887,000	1,386,000	1,455,600	1,937,600	1,365,000
IFRS net profits	554,496	5,627,400	8,347,300	9,990,600	18,284	40,662	87,810	407,740	842,165	1,355,706	1,455,400	1,974,129	1,360,000
Non-GAAP EBITDA	1,187,924	8,478,400	12,332,300	14,742,800	124,886	165,763	221,982	675,293	1,402,100	2,065,810	2,165,900	2,844,573	
IFRS EBITDA	1,183,195	8,428,400	12,332,300	14,742,800	124,886	164,773	220,334	673,202	1,346,117	2,072,210	2,165,900	2,844,173	
YoY % change													
Sales	*+37%*	*+332%*	*+40%*	*+19%*	*-20%*	*-7%*	*+21%*	*+189%*	*+415%*	*+453%*	*+373%*	*+228%*	*+360%*
Non-GAAP operating profits	*+93%*	*+828%*	*+47%*	*+20%*	*-64%*	*-48%*	*+18%*	*+1499%*	*+2833%*	*+2181%*	*+1339%*	*+357%*	*+1283%*
Non-GAAP EBITDA	*+55%*	*+614%*	*+45%*	*+20%*	*-39%*	*-32%*	*+11%*	*+489%*	*+1023%*	*+1146%*	*+876%*	*+321%*	
Non-GAAP Net profits	*+110%*	*+912%*	*+47%*	*+20%*	*-74%*	*-62%*	*+17%*	*+433%*	*+4693%*	*+3328%*	*+1526%*	*+371%*	*+1425%*
Margins													
Non-GAAP operating profits	37.5%	80.5%	84.2%	84.7%	13.2%	19.4%	26.6%	59.7%	75.0%	80.2%	81.0%	83.3%	80.0%
IFRS operating profits	37.2%	80.0%	84.2%	84.7%	13.1%	19.2%	26.3%	59.5%	71.9%	80.4%	80.9%	83.2%	79.8%
Non-GAAP EBITDA	50.8%	83.9%	87.0%	87.4%	36.4%	37.0%	40.8%	67.3%	79.3%	83.3%	84.3%	86.6%	
IFRS EBITDA	50.6%	83.4%	87.0%	87.4%	36.4%	36.8%	40.5%	67.1%	76.2%	83.6%	84.3%	86.6%	
Pre-tax profits	33.5%	79.6%	84.2%	84.6%	8.0%	12.7%	22.4%	57.7%	69.9%	79.4%	80.9%	83.9%	
Non-GAAP net profits	23.9%	56.1%	58.9%	59.2%	5.4%	9.0%	16.5%	41.0%	50.2%	55.9%	56.6%	59.0%	54.6%
IFRS net profits	23.7%	55.7%	58.9%	59.2%	5.3%	9.1%	16.2%	40.7%	47.7%	54.7%	56.6%	60.1%	54.4%
R&D	141,100	209,100	230,000	275,000	34,479	35,731	34,277	36,613	39,400	57,700	55,000	57,000	
(As a % of revenues)	6.0%	2.1%	1.6%	1.6%	10.1%	8.0%	6.3%	3.7%	2.2%	2.3%	2.1%	1.7%	
D&A	312,826	347,700	395,600	460,800	79,987	78,852	77,580	76,407	76,100	77,500	85,000	109,100	
(As a % of revenues)	13.4%	3.4%	2.8%	2.7%	23.3%	17.6%	14.3%	7.6%	4.3%	3.1%	3.3%	3.3%	
Gross capex	283,700	480,000	560,000	400,000	53,577	91,473	70,933	67,717	52,400	84,600	130,000	213,000	
(As a % of revenues)	12.1%	4.8%	4.0%	2.4%	15.6%	20.4%	13.0%	6.8%	3.0%	3.4%	5.1%	6.5%	
Net capex	221,000	457,000	560,000	400,000	34,107	72,768	61,327	52,798	39,100	75,200	130,000	212,700	
(As a % of revenues)	9.5%	4.5%	4.0%	2.4%	9.9%	16.2%	11.3%	5.3%	2.2%	3.0%	5.1%	6.5%	
			*1:3 Stock split as of Sep 30, 2026										
EPS(JPY)	1,024.1	3,519.2	5,388.7	6,847.4	33.9	75.3	162.4	752.4	1,539.9	2,508.1			
DPS(JPY)	0.0	300.0	500.0	700.0									
BPS(JPY)	2,561.7	3,593.8	6,548.7	8,937.7									
Sales by product													
SSD & storage	1,362,638	6,843,636	10,578,023	13,499,686	217,411	244,559	300,375	600,293	1,174,719	1,615,997	1,665,180	2,387,741	
Smart device	759,978	2,981,386	3,319,392	3,097,502	79,040	157,300	186,291	337,347	525,656	788,857	837,252	829,621	
Others	215,012	278,323	272,800	272,800	46,348	46,487	56,965	65,212	66,742	75,181	68,200	68,200	
Total	**2,337,628**	**10,103,300**	**14,170,200**	**16,870,000**	**342,799**	**448,346**	**543,631**	**1,002,852**	**1,767,117**	**2,480,035**	**2,570,600**	**3,285,600**	**2,500,000**
Sales related data													
USD/JPY					145	147	153	155	160	161	158	160	157
Shipment volume (Capacity basis, QoQ)					Flat	+High-30%	+MSD%	▲10%	+LSD%	+Low-teens	+2%	+10%	
ASP (USD, QoQ)					+HSD%	▲LSD%	+Low-teens%	+2x+	+70%	+25%	+4%	+14%	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment Thesis - Kioxia Holdings

We are Buy rated on Kioxia Holdings, the world's third-largest maker of NAND flash memory. We find Kioxia's relatively high profit margins (stemming from strong cost competitiveness) and gradual progress in developing products for data centers, a segment expected to see high growth within the NAND market, as positive. NAND supply/demand is tightening due to rising demand for enterprise SSDs (eSSDs) for servers, tightness in HDDs (which are also used for storage applications), and concerns over US export controls on production equipment (for fabs of major South Korean memory makers located in China), resulting in continued increases in NAND prices in CY27. Although we maintain our view that the structure of the NAND market itself has not changed (i.e., cyclicality remains as there are still more players compared to the HDD and DRAM markets, which are dominated by 2-3 major companies), we believe higher profit levels compared to previous cycles can be sustained, and the market will recognize that profit levels over the next 2-3 years will be higher than its expectations as well as sustainable. This view is based on (1) the possibility that tight supply/demand will continue into CY28, as AI demand remains strong while near-term supply increases are limited, (2) major memory makers continuing to prioritize investment in DRAM, and (3) a path having been paved for procuring DRAM (used in eSSDs). Kioxia shares are currently trading at a FY3/28E P/E of around 2.5X based on our estimates, suggesting that sentiment remains largely skeptical over the sustainability of the high level of earnings at present. However, we highlight that, following the recent share price correction, the shareholder return yield, combining our dividend and share buyback estimates for

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FY3/28, has risen to just under 20%, offering a compelling risk/reward profile.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Kioxia Holdings
Valuation methodology: Our 12-month target price of ¥39,000 is based on the correlation between ROE-P/B and the average of our FY3/27-FY3/28 ROE estimates (implies FY3/28E P/E 7.2X, P/B 6.0X).

Key risks: A slowdown in AI investment centered on hyperscalers, the rise of NAND players in China, decline in profit margins due to cost increases or fluctuations in capacity utilization, a sharp appreciation of the yen against the US dollar, and a slowdown in NAND demand for non-AI applications.

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Disclosure Appendix

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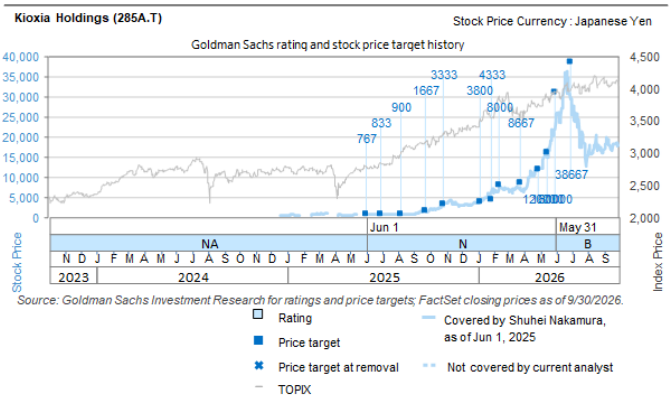
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	Buy	Hold	Sell	Buy	Hold	Sell
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Target price history table(s)

Kioxia Holdings (285A.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
18-Oct-26	39,000	13,375
30-Jun-26	116,000	29,893
31-May-26	93,000	21,950
15-May-26	48,000	14,817
28-Apr-26	36,000	12,107
25-Mar-26	26,000	7,482
12-Feb-26	24,000	7,058
30-Jan-26	13,000	7,120
06-Jan-26	11,400	3,867
29-Oct-25	10,000	3,360
23-Sep-25	5,000	1,607
08-Aug-25	2,700	788
30-Jun-25	2,500	834
01-Jun-25	2,300	700

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